User Guide

How to use the Penumbra Organizer plugin, tab by tab. For what the plugin is and why it exists, see the main README.md. For the classification and sort logic mentioned below, see HOW_SORTING_WORKS.md.

Getting the plugin

Most users should install through the self-hosted plugin repository described in README.md. That's the supported path, and it auto-updates. If you're building from source or loading a local dev build instead, see DEVELOPMENT.md.

Title bar

Three icon buttons sit in the title bar, to the left of Dalamud's own icons. Each opens a page in your browser:

- **Code icon:** the plugin's GitHub repository.
- **Chat icon:** the Discord server, for help.
- **Mug icon:** the Ko-fi page, if you want to support the project.

Hover over each one to see what it opens.

About the pictures

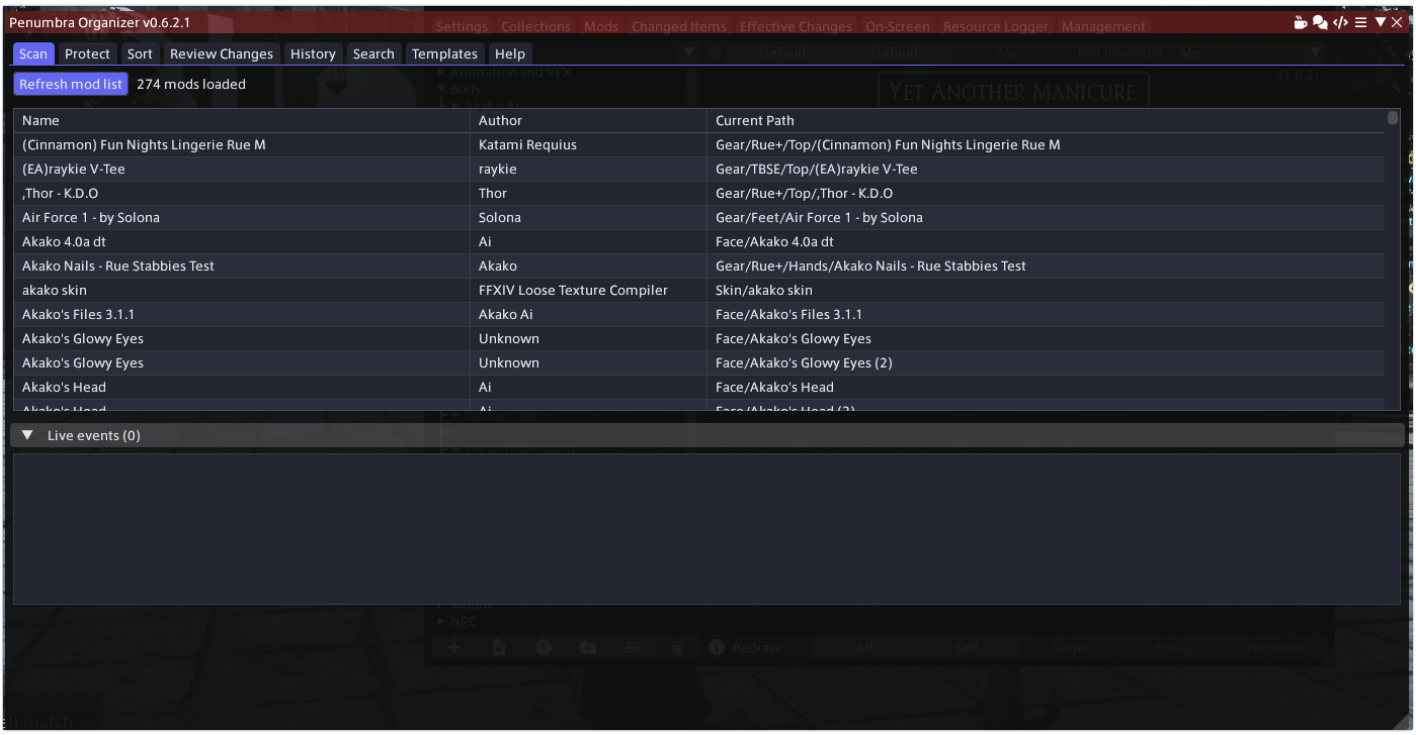
The screenshots below are rendered from a faithful mock of the plugin's window (`docs/ui-mock/`), using the plugin's own colours and the exact control labels from its code. They show the layout and wording you will see; your own numbers, mod names and folder names will differ.

Requirements

Dalamud, via XIVLauncher. Penumbra installed and enabled: every tab depends on Penumbra's IPC being available, and if Penumbra isn't running, Refresh mod list shows a connection error instead of a mod list.

The eight tabs

Scan



This is where every session starts. Nothing anywhere else in the plugin updates by itself.

Refresh mod list

Re-reads every installed mod from Penumbra (`GetModList`) along with its full changed-items set (`GetChangedItems`), then classifies each one. See HOW_SORTING_WORKS.md for how classification works.

Run it first, and run it again whenever mods are installed, removed, or moved outside the plugin. Scanning never moves anything; it only reads.

While a scan runs

The scan runs in the background, so the game keeps responding. A progress line replaces the button while it works, with a Cancel button beside it. Cancelling leaves your previously loaded library exactly as it was.

Anything that would collide with a running scan is disabled while it runs, each with a note saying why: Apply, Restore, Create Backup, Folder Cleanup, the Sort controls, and Import Workbook.

Two situations end a scan early, both on purpose:

- **Your mod list changed mid-scan.** If you add, remove, or move a mod in Penumbra while a scan is running, its results no longer describe your library, so they are discarded rather than shown. You are told the mod list changed and asked to run it again.
- **The mod list changed during the initial snapshot.** The scan stops straight away rather than spending time on a snapshot that may already be out of date.

Neither leaves anything half-applied. A discarded scan simply leaves the previous one in place.

What the tab shows afterwards

A count of how many mods are loaded, and the library itself: name, author and current path. Protected mods are drawn in the protected colour, so you can see at a glance what Sort will leave alone.

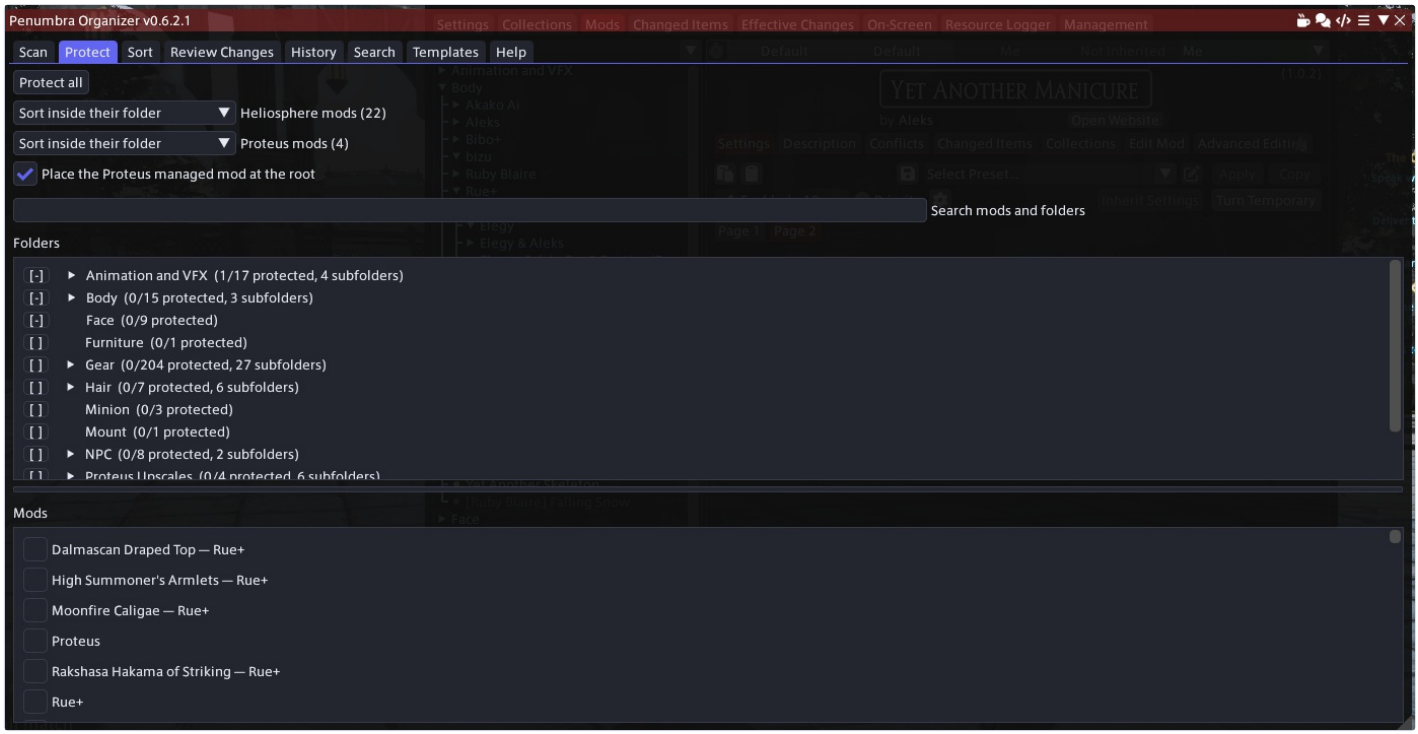
At the bottom, **Live events (ModAdded / ModDeleted / ModMoved)** reports those events as Penumbra raises them. It is informational only — it does not trigger a re-scan, which is why the rule above is to scan again yourself after installing mods.

If Penumbra is not available

Every tab depends on Penumbra's IPC. If Penumbra is not running or not enabled, Refresh mod list reports a connection error instead of a mod list. Start Penumbra and scan again.

Protect

Protection is what stops the plugin proposing a move for a mod. A protected mod keeps its current path through every Sort and is skipped by Apply. Nothing on this tab moves anything by itself.



A search box at the top filters both lists below it by mod name, author, identifier, current path, or folder path. Clear it to see everything again.

Three sources of protection

A mod is protected if **any** of these is true, and the tab tells you which one applies:

1. **Its own checkbox**, in the Mods list.
2. **A folder rule** covering the folder it sits in. The note beside the mod reads `(via folder: Gear)`, naming the folder whose rule actually decided it.
3. **A tool manages it**, shown as `(Heliosphere)` or `(Proteus)`. By default the plugin leaves these mods where they are. You can change that per tool; see Heliosphere and Proteus mods below.

These are independent. Freeing a mod means clearing whichever source is protecting it, which is why the notes name the source rather than only saying "protected".

The folder tree

Folders shows every folder your mods occupy, plus any folder that carries a rule but no longer holds anything, as a collapsible tree. Click the arrow to open a folder. Each row shows how many of its mods are protected out of how many it holds at any depth, and how many subfolders are under it. Folders you open stay open the next time you open the window. The list is resizable: drag the thin bar just below it.

Every row has one box with three states, and clicking it cycles through them:

Box	Meaning
`[ ]`	**No rule.** This folder follows whatever the nearest folder above it says.
`[x]`	**Protected.** Nothing in this folder or below it is moved.
`[-]`	**Excluded.** This folder and everything below it may be sorted, *even if a parent is protected.*

The nearest rule wins. A rule applies down the tree until a deeper folder sets its own. That is what makes "protect this folder, except that one subfolder inside it" possible, and you can keep nesting: protect `haloween`, exclude `haloween/animation`, then protect `haloween/animation/keep` inside that if you want.

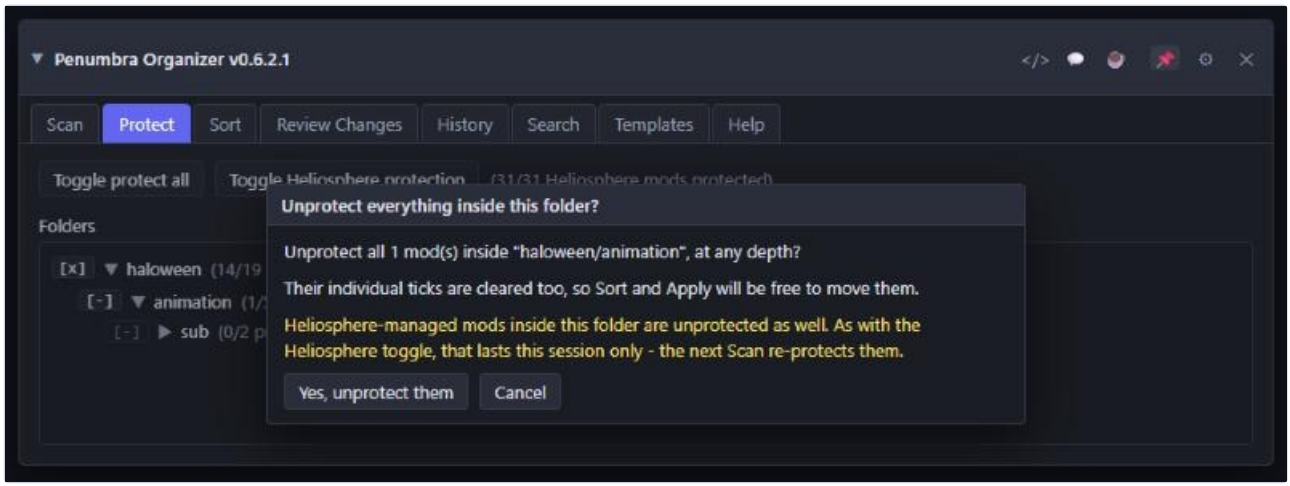
A **dim** box means the state was inherited from a folder above; hover it to see which one. A **solid** box means this folder sets its own rule. Clicking a dim box gives that folder its own rule first, so going from an inherited `[x]` to an excluded `[-]` takes two clicks: the first click's only visible effect is the box turning solid.

A folder that still carries a rule after its mods have moved away is listed as **(currently empty)**, so a rule can never become invisible.

What an exclude does not free

An exclude withdraws the **folder's** protection and nothing else. Inside an excluded folder, a mod you ticked yourself stays protected, and so does a tool-managed one (while its mode is Protected). That is deliberate: those are per-mod decisions, and a folder rule has no business reversing them silently.

To clear those as well, use the **Unprotect N inside** button on the folder's row. It clears protection from every mod under it at any depth whatever the source - its own tick, Protect all, a folder rule, or a tool - and asks first.

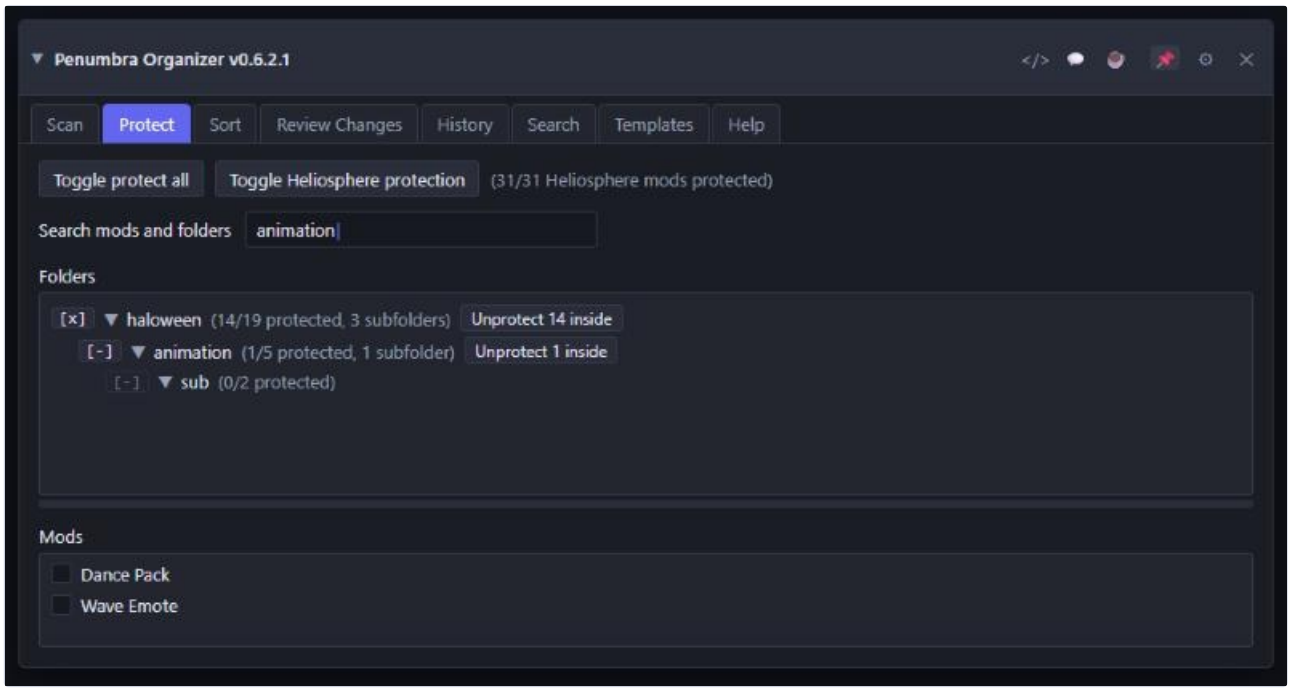


The count on the button is what it can actually free, so if there is nothing left to free there is no button. Three details worth knowing:

- On a folder you have **excluded**, the button leaves the exclude in place and clears only the per-mod protection inside. If it withdrew the exclude, the subfolder would fall straight back under its protected parent and everything you just freed would be re-protected.
- The button never overrides a protected parent on its own. Escaping a parent is the box's job, and takes a deliberate click.
- Unprotecting a tool's mods this way lasts the session only: the next Scan re-applies the tool's mode.

Searching the tree

Typing in the search box narrows the tree to the branches that match and opens them for you, so a match several levels down is visible without digging. Clearing the search puts the tree back exactly as you had it - what a search opens is never saved. While a search is running, folders stay open.



The Mods list

Mods lists every scanned mod with its own checkbox, in its own scrollable area below the folders. A protected mod is excluded from every grouping and from Apply: its proposed path always stays equal to its current path, and if anything does touch a protected mod, Review Changes flags it as a "protected mod changed" error.

Protect all protects every mod; once everything is protected the same button reads **Unprotect all** and clears every protection, including ones you ticked yourself.

Manually unprotecting a mod persists across scans; that choice, along with your folder rules, is saved to the plugin's own config.

Heliosphere and Proteus mods

Heliosphere and Proteus each manage some of your mods. Both find their mods by directory rather than by where they sit in Penumbra's tree, so the plugin may move them, but you choose. When the scan finds mods from a tool, the Protect tab shows a dropdown for it with the number of mods:

- **Protected** (the default): left exactly where they are.
- **Sort inside their folder**: sorted like any other mod, but kept beneath the top-level folder they already sit in (`Proteus Upscales/Gear/Top/...`). Mods at the very top level, or already in one of the sorter's own folders such as `Gear`, are sorted normally.
- **Treat as normal**: sorted like everything else.

The choice is saved. A tool with no mods in your library shows no dropdown, so the Proteus controls appear only once the scan finds a Proteus-made mod. Heliosphere mods are detected by the `hs-` directory prefix, Heliosphere's `[HS]` name prefix, a `heliosphere.json` file in the mod folder, or having been recognised on an earlier scan. Proteus-made mods are the ones whose `meta.json` author is exactly `Proteus`.

Proteus also keeps one mod of its own, named `Proteus`. Once it exists, the tab offers **Place the Proteus managed mod at the root**, which files that mod at the very top of the library instead of inside the Proteus folder.

An explicit protection you set yourself (a ticked mod, or a protected folder) still beats a tool's mode.

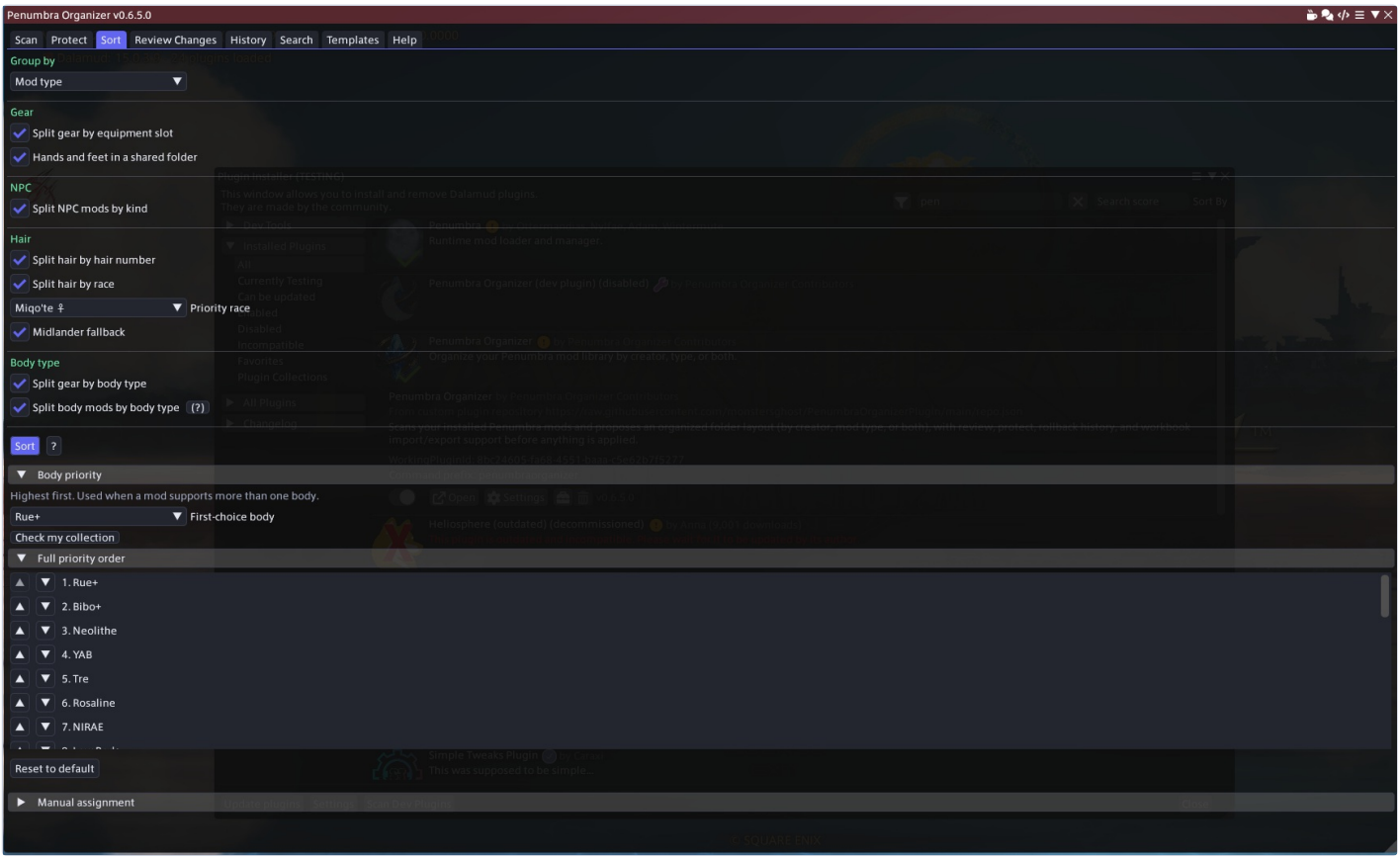
Two things that catch people out

Protected mods at the top level. If any protected mods sit at the very top level of your library, outside every folder, the tab says so in yellow. That combination is a dead end: protection means the plugin never proposes a path, so sorting will never file them away and they stay there indefinitely. Heliosphere and Proteus install new mods there and, in Protected mode, they are protected by the same scan that first notices them, so this can happen without you doing anything. Untick one and it sorts like any other mod.

Protect all, then free one folder. Protect all writes a tick on every *mod* and ticks no folder, so there is no folder to untick afterwards and Sort reports "apply to 0 mods". The way to do it is Protect all, then **Unprotect N inside** on the one folder you want filed away.

Protection governs Sort and Apply only. Restoring a snapshot from the History tab reproduces its recorded paths regardless of current protection. See History below.

Sort



Choose a grouping, tick whichever splits you want, and press Sort. That computes a proposed folder path for every unprotected mod **without moving anything**. Only Apply, on the Review Changes tab, calls Penumbra.

The tab has three sections: **Group by** and the **Sort** button, which are always visible; then **Gear, NPC and Hair**; then **Body type**. The two lower sections are collapsed away until you want them. The **?** button beside Sort opens the Help tab at its Sort section, and the small **(?)** beside a checkbox explains it.

Everything on this tab is remembered between sessions: Group by, every checkbox, the hair race, the Midlander fallback and the body priority. Only the proposals themselves reset (on a rescan).

Group by

This picks the shape of the path:

Choice	Result
Creator	`{Creator}/{ModName}`
Mod type	`{Category}[/{SubCategory}]/{ModName}`
Type then creator	`{Category}[/{SubCategory}]/{Creator}/{ModName}`
Creator then type	`{Creator}/{Category}[/{SubCategory}]/{ModName}`

A mod with no resolvable creator, category, or both, falls back to `Review/{ModName}`, so it is easy to find and sort by hand instead of landing somewhere unexpected.

Every split checkbox is greyed out when Group by is Creator, because grouping by creator alone never looks at a mod's type. A ticked hair box keeps its two dependent controls visible but greyed, and switching Group by back restores everything untouched.

The splits

Split gear by equipment slot puts gear mods in `Gear/Feet`, `Gear/Head` and so on, wherever the slot can be determined from a single unambiguous match. Anything ambiguous — a real multi-piece outfit — or unidentifiable falls back to the plain `Gear` folder. The Export on Review Changes breaks down how many resolved, how many were ambiguous, and how many had no equipment evidence at all, which is the fastest way to find out why a mod did not land where you expected.

Split NPC mods by kind puts NPC mods in `NPC/NPCs`, `NPC/Bosses` or `NPC/Enemies`. Turning it **off puts every NPC mod straight into** `NPC` with no subfolder. That combination did not exist in earlier versions, where NPC mods were always subdivided; if you preferred the old behaviour, leave it ticked, as it is by default.

Split hair by hair number puts a hair mod in a folder named after the vanilla hair number it replaces, such as `Hair/115`, when the mod targets exactly one number. A mod that targets two or more numbers, or whose files could not be read, stays directly in `Hair`, as does every hair mod while this is off. The numbers come from the mod's own configuration, not its name. It is off by default. Folder numbers are padded to three digits (`Hair/002`, `Hair/053`, `Hair/185`) so Penumbra, which sorts folders as text, lists them in numeric order. Numbers of 1000 or more are not padded.

Two controls appear under it, and both apply only while Split hair is on:

- **Priority race.** Pick a race and gender. A hair mod that uses exactly one hair number for that race is filed under that number, whatever the other races use — a mod using 169 for most races and 3 for Viera goes to `Hair/3` with Viera female chosen.
- **Midlander fallback.** When a mod uses different numbers across races, this uses the Midlander number if male and female Midlanders agree.

A mod that still does not resolve to one number stays in the plain `Hair` folder; a race with two hair numbers in the same mod never picks one.

Split gear by body type puts a gear mod in a folder named after the body it was made for, such as `Gear/Bibo+/Top`. The body comes before the equipment slot, so everything made for one body sits together instead of being spread across the nine slot folders. It is off by default. The slot split is separate: turn that off and you get `Gear/Bibo+` with nothing below it.

Numbered gear folders. With both gear splits on, `Gear/` is numbered so nothing sits loose: `00. Sets` (outfits and gear with no single slot), `01. Head`, `02. Top`, `03. Hands`, `04. Legs`, `05. Feet`, `06. Ears`, `07. Neck`, `08. Wrists`, `09. Rings`, then one folder per body from `10.`, in Body priority order, such as `10. Rue+` and `11. Bibo+`. Only bodies that have gear get a folder, and each holds the same numbered slot folders (`10. Rue+/02. Top`). Reordering Body priority, or a body gaining or losing gear, renumbers the body folders. With only one of the two splits on, the layout is as before, without numbers.

Hands and feet in a shared folder (off by default; it needs Split gear by equipment slot and only does anything with Split gear by body type on) files gloves, gauntlets, boots and nails under `Gear/03. Hands` and `Gear/05. Feet` instead of under each body, since they fit most bodies. Tops, legs and sets still go under their body. A body that only had hands or feet mods no longer gets a folder.

Split hair by race (off by default) files hair made for one race under that race, such as `Hair/Viera`. Hair made for several races, or with no race found, goes under `Hair/Multi-race`. With Split hair by hair number also on, the number is added below, as in `Hair/Viera/115`. With it off you get just the race folder.

What moves and what stops matching after you update:

- a) The first sort after updating moves gear and hair folders once. History restores the old layout.
- b) Template `folderLabels` keyed to the old subfolders (`Gear/Legs`, `Gear/Bibo+`, `Hair/2`) stop matching. A key on `Gear` itself still renames the root.
- c) A hair mod protected at `Hair/2` stays there, beside the new `Hair/002`.
- d) Folder protection rules naming the old gear folders no longer match the renamed ones.

Split body mods by body type does the same for the body replacers themselves, filing each under its own body name, such as `Body/Rue+`. It is a separate checkbox so you can split one kind and not the other: with only the gear box ticked, body mods stay as `Body/<mod>`, and the reverse. With it on, the Body folder is numbered so it sorts the same regardless of the alphabet: `00. Skeleton`, `01. Physics` and `02. Tails, Ears and Horns` are shared and sit on top, then your bodies from `10.` in your Body priority order (only bodies that have body mods), each holding `00. Replacer`, `01. SFW` (clothing that covers the body, like lingerie) and `02. Hands and Feet`, for example `Body/10. Rue+/01. SFW/<mod>`. A mod that is not clearly a part stays in Replacer, and a body mod with no body stays directly in `Body`. A mod that is not clearly a part stays in Replacer. For example `Body/Rue+/Skeleton/<mod>`.

Check my collection sits in the Sort tab's Body priority section. It reads the mods enabled in your active collection (the one that affects your character, or Penumbra's selected collection when that is unavailable) and counts only body replacer mods. If exactly one body is enabled it names it and offers **Make first choice**; with none or several it says so and changes nothing. It says which collection it read. It counts enabled replacer mods from their metadata; it does not prove which body's files win in game, because mod priority and options can still decide that.

The body comes from the mod's options and files first (option group names, option names and the first folder of its file paths), then its name, then the library folder it sits in. For a body mod the order is reversed: its own name wins over its option groups, because a body replacer often carries option groups for the other bodies it is merely compatible with ("Yet Another Body+" ships a Bibo+ option and is still a YAB mod). The plugin knows 30 bodies and 120 ways of writing them, including `Bibo+`, `Rue+`, `YAB`, `TnF`, `TF3`, `TBSE` and `Neolithe`. Variants go in with their parent, so a TBSE-X mod lands in `Gear/TBSE` and a YAB Buff mod in `Gear/YAB`.

Only gear that a body changes the shape of is looked at: the Top, Hands, Legs and Feet slots, which are the four pieces a body mod replaces. Weapons, hats, earrings, necklaces, bracelets and rings never get a body folder, so a weapon called "Artemis Bow" stays where it is instead of being filed under the Artemis body.

A mod with no body anywhere gets no body subfolder; ordinary sorting can still place it. A mod that merely happens to have a body's name in its title can end up filed under it. Review Changes shows every move before anything happens, so one wrong guess is one line to put right.

You can add bodies it does not know, or fix one it has wrong, by creating `body-type-list.json` in the configuration folder. Give your entry the same `Label` as a body already in the list and yours replaces it, which is how you remove a spelling that turns out to be wrong instead of only adding to it. The file is read only if it is there, and the plugin says so in the log if it cannot use part of it: an entry it had to ignore, or a name you reused that a different body already answers to.

After sorting

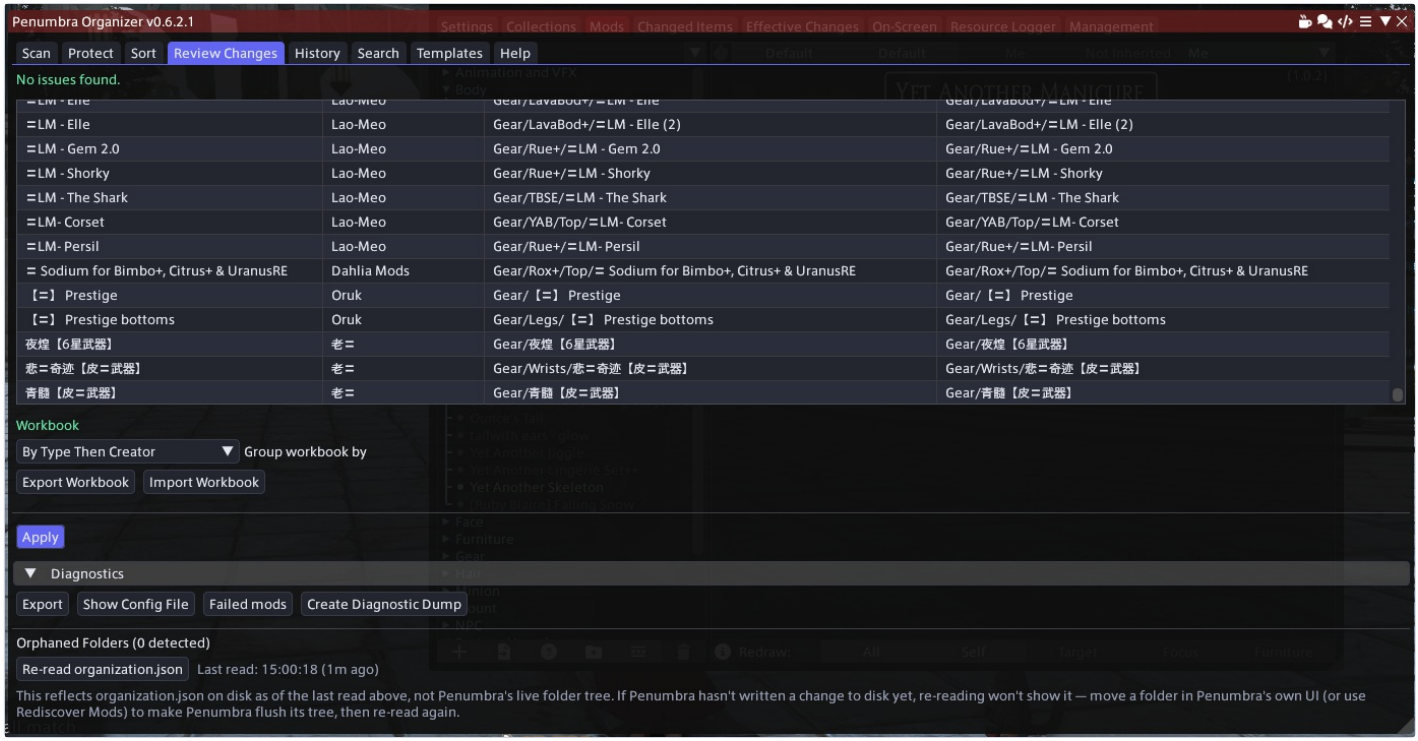
If you change the grouping or any checkbox after sorting, a line appears reminding you that the selection no longer matches what was sorted. Press Sort again to bring the proposals up to date. Sorting again always recomputes from scratch, so it is safe to press repeatedly.

Manual assignment

A collapsed section at the bottom of the tab, closed by default, assigns a folder to specific mods. Its own **Search mods** box filters the list below it, the same way the Protect tab's does. Check the mods you want — protected mods never appear here — type a destination folder, and click **Assign N selected mods**. Each checked mod's proposed path becomes `{destination}/{ModName}`.

A summary line reports how many were assigned and how many were skipped, for example because a mod stopped being eligible after you checked it, or because you left the folder box empty. Your checked selection survives changes to the search box, so you can filter down, check some mods, clear the filter, and check more without losing what you already picked.

Review Changes



The gate between a proposal and your actual library. Everything above this tab is reversible by doing nothing; this is where you commit.

The validation line and the table

The top line is the result of `Validate()`. Any **protected-mod-changed** or **path-collision** errors are listed in red, and Apply stays disabled while any exist. The table below shows every mod's current path beside its proposed path, so you can read the whole change before committing.

- A **protected mod changed** error means something assigned a proposed path to a mod you protected. It is a bug-catcher: protection is supposed to make that impossible.
- A **path collision** means two mods would end up at the same path. Penumbra would reject or mangle one of them, so the plugin refuses first.

Protect & Skip All Blocking Mods is the one-click fix: every mod currently blocking Apply — whether protected-but-changed or on the losing side of a collision — has its proposed path reset to its current path and gets protected. Apply becomes available without you tracking down each one.

Apply

Apply is disabled while any validation issue exists. When you click it, a confirmation popup shows how many mods will move; confirming calls Penumbra's `SetModPath` for every mod whose proposed path differs from its current path.

The result shows a succeeded and failed count, with Penumbra's own error code as the reason for each failure, for example `PathRenameFailed`. When some mods failed, a **Show failed mods** button beside that line opens a small window naming each mod that could not be moved, the reason Penumbra gave, and the path it was being moved to. Apply also captures a snapshot of your library just before it runs, so you can always get back to where you started — see History below.

Workbook

A **Workbook** group above Apply holds everything for the Excel round trip:

- **Group workbook by** decides what goes in the workbook's Destination column. The four sorting choices fill it with suggested folders; **Keep current folders (as-is)** fills it with each mod's folder as it stands, which is what you want when you intend to write the layout yourself. Protected mods and mods at the top level of your library get a blank Destination, which means "leave this one alone" on import.
- **Export Workbook** writes `organizer-workbook.xlsx`, interoperable with the standalone app. **Open Workbook** opens the file you just wrote.
- **Import Workbook** opens a file picker for an `.xlsx` exported from this plugin or the standalone app and applies its per-mod destination folders as proposed paths. Use it instead of the built-in groupings when you want to hand-edit an assignment list in Excel first. It works with a scan loaded and nothing staged, and stays greyed while a scan runs. A summary line, plus any errors or warnings, appears below the buttons once the import finishes.

Apply sits below the group, in the plugin's purple, set apart from the rest.

Diagnostics

A collapsed section, closed by default:

- **Export** writes every mod's full field set plus the validation result to a plain-text file (`organizer-export.txt`, overwritten each time). Each mod lists its detected body type and the evidence behind it, and whether a tool manages it (`ManagedBy:`). If any of your mods are Gear, it adds the one-line slot-resolution summary described under Sort. It is a snapshot to read, not something to re-import.
- **Show Config File** opens Explorer with the plugin's own settings file (your protected mods, folder rules and Sort choices) selected, so you can copy or attach it.
- **Failed mods** opens the same window as the button beside the Apply result, for the most recently finished Apply or Restore.
- **Create Diagnostic Dump** writes a plain-text state summary - mod and protection counts (including Heliosphere- and Proteus-managed ones), the last Apply/Restore/Folder Cleanup result including one from a previous session, and the session's event log - to `organizer-diagnostics.txt`, and **Show Dump File** opens Explorer with it selected. Attach that file when reporting a problem.

Orphaned Folders

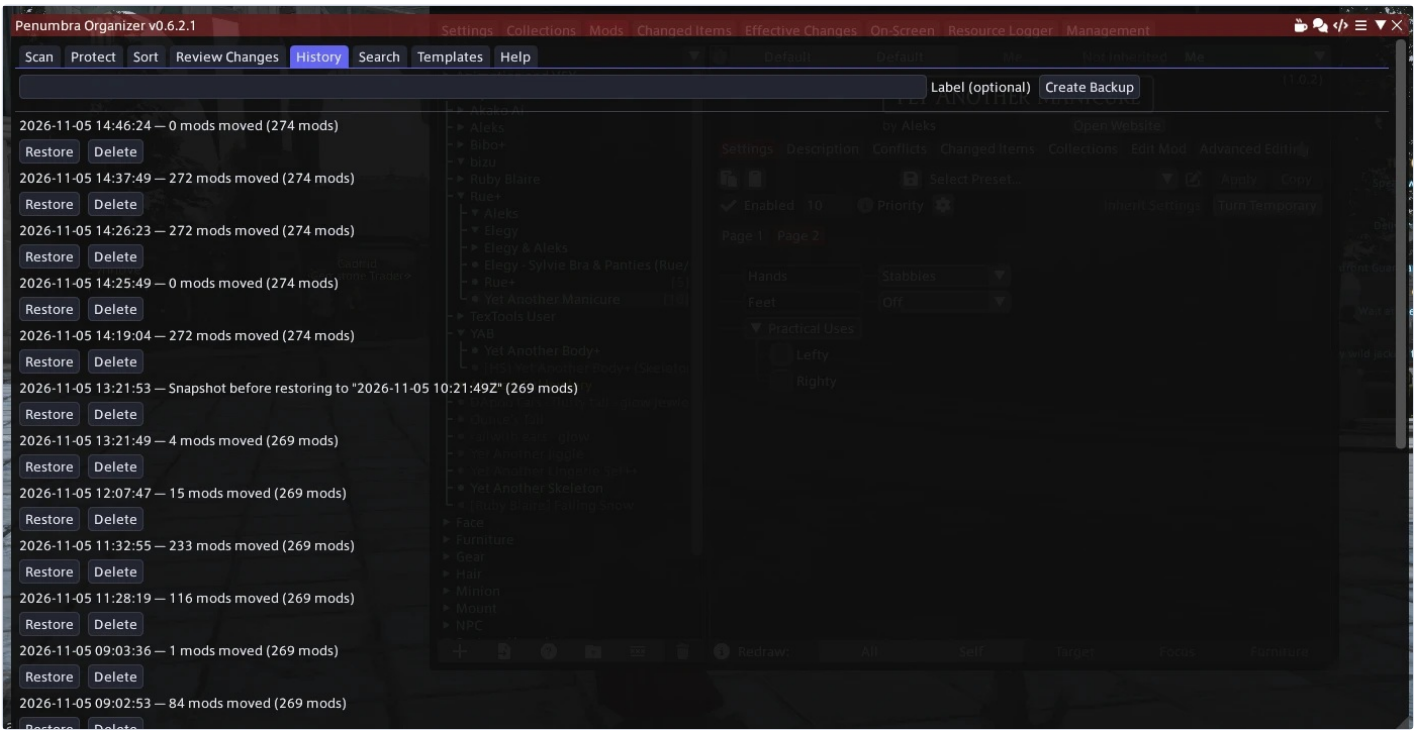
Below a separator, this section appears once you have scanned at least once. It finds folder entries left behind in Penumbra's own `organization.json` after a mod moved out of them.

Re-read organization.json, with a "Last read" timestamp beside it, re-reads the file from disk. It does **not** ask Penumbra to refresh its own live folder tree, which is why the count can look wrong right after a big Sort or Restore. If it does, move one folder in Penumbra's own UI (or click its Rediscover Mods) and re-read.

Plain empty folders are pre-checked. Folders that still carry your own customization — an icon, colour, or name override — are shown unchecked for you to review before pruning, because deleting one throws that customization away.

Clean Up Selected Folders removes the checked entries, with its own backup and **Rollback Folder Cleanup** pair, separate from Apply's history. Afterwards a banner reminds you to click Rediscover Mods in Penumbra's settings, since this plugin has no IPC call that can trigger that reload itself.

History



The undo for everything this plugin does to your library.

What gets captured

Every Apply and every Restore automatically captures a snapshot just before it runs, so both are undoable. You can also click **Create Backup** at any time, with an optional label, to save one on demand — worth doing before a big reorganisation you are unsure about.

Each entry shows when it was captured, its label or an auto-generated description such as "1723 mods moved", and how many mods it covers. History persists across game restarts.

Restoring

Clicking **Restore** opens a confirmation with an exact preview:

- how many mods will move to their snapshot path;
- how many are already at it;
- how many, installed since the snapshot was taken, will be moved to the Penumbra root;
- how many, uninstalled since, will be skipped.

If any mods in that preview are currently protected or Heliosphere-managed, a warning line tells you how many will move anyway.

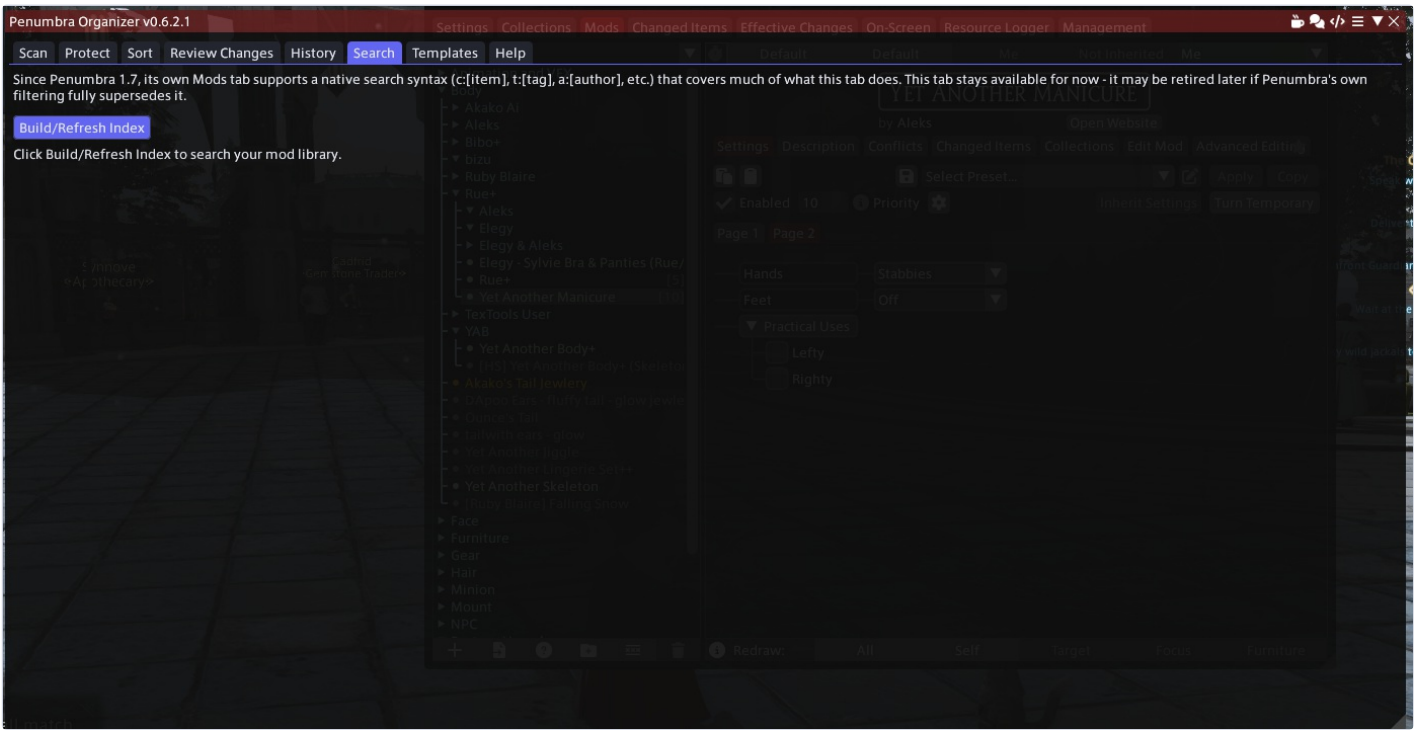
That is deliberate: **Restore ignores protection.** A snapshot is a record of where your mods were, and current sort protection should not be able to stop you getting back to it. Only two things stop a mod being restored — it is no longer installed (reported as skipped), or Penumbra's `SetModPath` rejects the move (reported as failed, with Penumbra's error code).

Confirming a Restore captures its own pre-restore snapshot first, so a restore is itself undoable.

Delete

Removes a snapshot from the list. Restoring to any other snapshot still works normally afterwards. Deleting a snapshot does not touch your mods.

Search



A read-only reverse lookup: find every installed mod, enabled or not, by the game items it changes. It is independent of the Sort tab, builds its own index, and never moves, protects, or modifies anything.

Build/Refresh Index

Scans your installed mods and their changed-items sets into a searchable index. This is **separate from the Scan tab's scan**, so click it once here before searching, and again after installing or removing mods. A summary line reports what was indexed — mod count, total changed items, and a gear-slot breakdown — with the build time beneath it.

Like the Scan tab's scan, it runs in the background with a progress line and a Cancel button, and is discarded if your mod list changes while it is running.

Narrowing the results

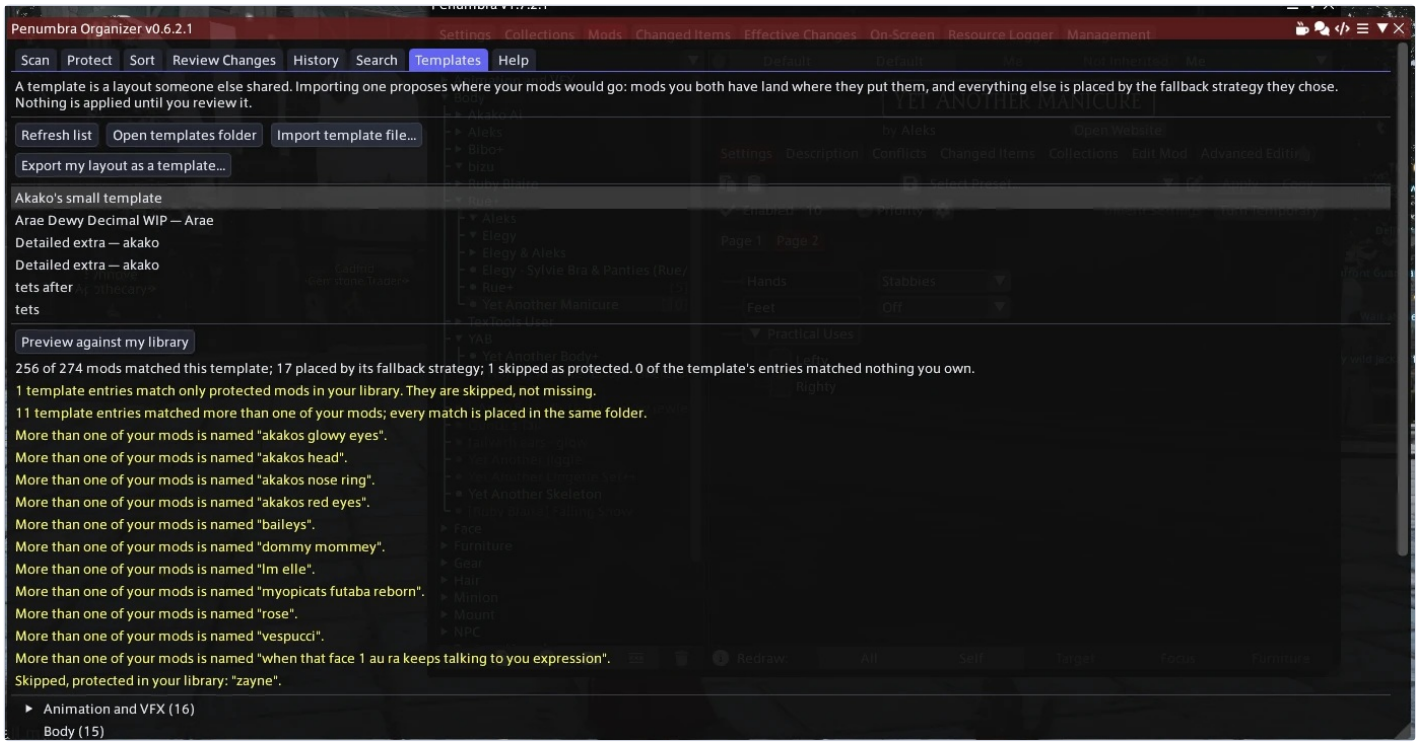
- **Mod name contains** matches the mod's name.
- **Item contains** matches the names of the items it changes.
- **Categories** filters by mod category, with an Unknown toggle for mods that did not classify.
- **Slots** appears when Gear is among the selected categories, filtering Gear mods by equipment slot, plus an Unresolved toggle for Gear mods whose slot could not be determined.

Reading the results

The left pane lists matching mods as `Name (Author)`; click one to select it. The right pane lists that mod's changed items.

If a mod matched only because of the **Mod name contains** box and not because of any item, a red "Matched by mod name, not by item" note appears above its item list. That distinction matters when you are hunting for which mod touches an item: a name hit is a coincidence of naming, an item hit is the real answer.

Templates



A template is an organization layout someone else shared as a `.json` file. Importing one proposes where your mods would go: mods you and the template's author both have land in the folder they chose, and everything else is placed by the fallback sort strategy they picked, using their folder names.

Using someone else's template

1. Get a template file from whoever shared it and click **Import template file...**, or drop the file into the templates folder yourself (**Open templates folder** shows you where) and click **Refresh list**.
2. Select it in the list to see who made it and what it is for.
3. Click **Preview against my library**. You get a count of how many of your mods the template matched, how many its fallback strategy placed, and a browsable tree of the resulting folders with the number of mods in each.
4. If it looks right, click **Apply this template to my proposals**, then open **Review Changes** to check the result and apply it like any other sort.

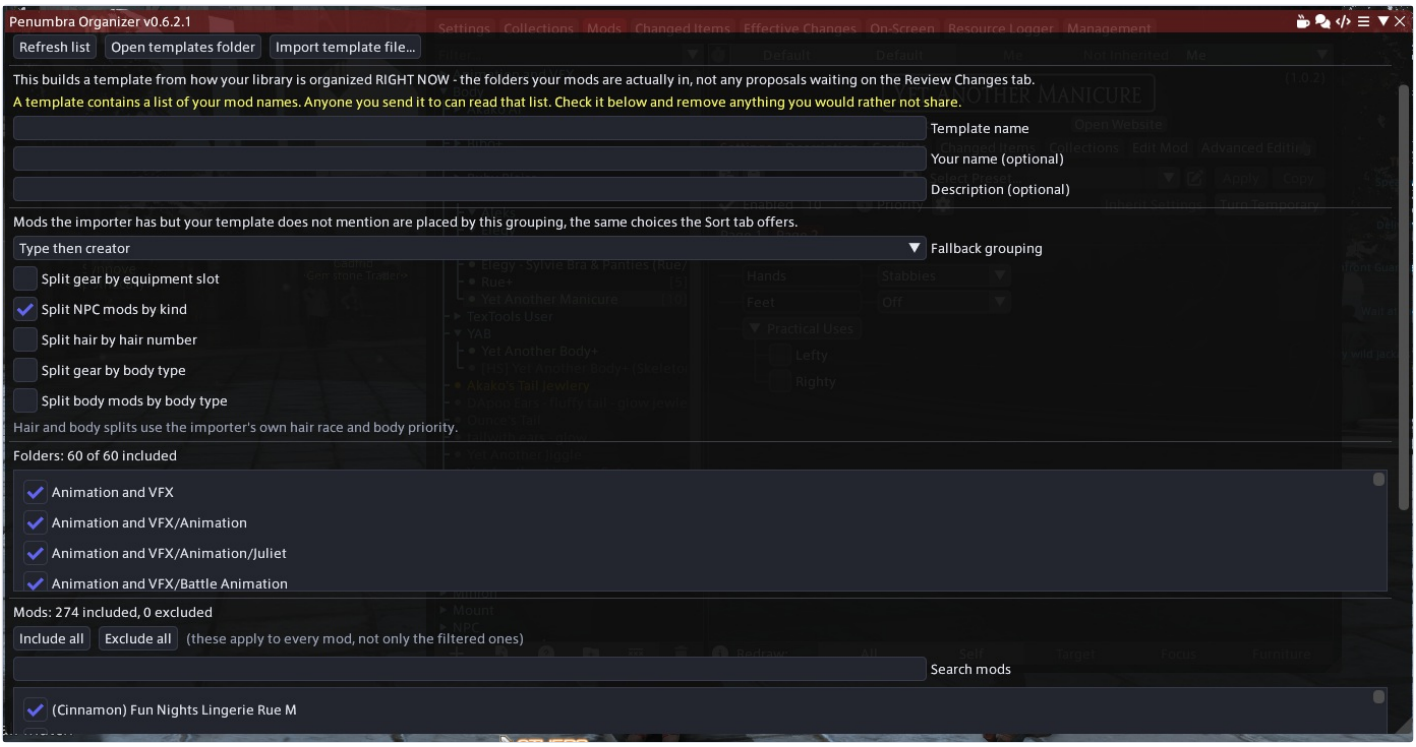
Nothing is written to Penumbra until you apply from Review Changes, exactly as when you sort from the Sort tab.

A few things worth knowing:

- **A template never sees your mod list.** It matches on mod names, so it only affects mods you already have. Mods its author never had are placed by the fallback strategy, not left behind.
- **Matching is on the mod's name**, ignoring case, install suffixes like `_1_1_0`, and bracketed tags. A mod you renamed will not match, and will be placed by the fallback strategy instead.
- **Protected mods are never moved**, the same as with any sort. Heliosphere and Proteus mods follow the mode you chose on the Protect tab: under Sort inside their folder, a template still keeps them beneath their tool's folder, and the Proteus managed mod still goes to the root if you asked for that.
- **The fallback's hair and body splits use your settings.** If the template's author ticked a hair or body split, it turns that split on for the mods the template does not mention, but which hair race and which body order applies is your own Sort tab setting. A template made before these options existed has them off and behaves exactly as it always did.
- If you rescan your library after previewing, the preview is discarded — preview again before applying.

Sharing your own layout

Export my layout as a template... builds a template from your library.



Read this part before you use it: **a template contains a list of your mod names, and anyone you send it to can read that list.** That is the whole point of the format — it is how an importer knows which of their mods you have an opinion about — but it means exporting is publishing. If any of your mods are things you would not want a stranger, or a friend, reading off a list, take them out first.

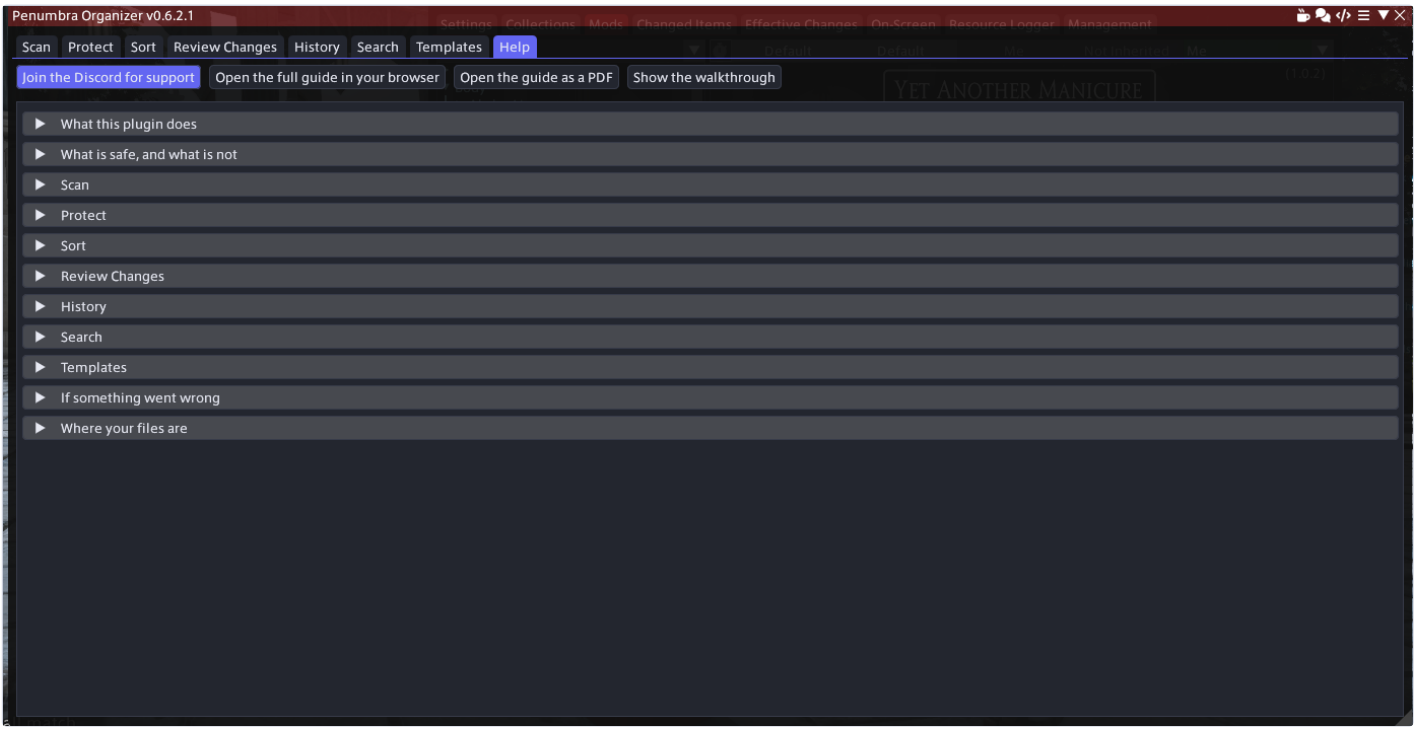
That is what the review screen is for, and there is no way to export without going through it:

1. Click **Export my layout as a template...**. The screen opens with **everything included**, so what you see is your actual library.
2. Give it a name, and optionally your name and a description.
3. Pick the **fallback grouping** — where an importer's mods go when your template says nothing about them. These are the same choices the Sort tab offers, including the gear, NPC, hair and body-type splits. Your choices here are remembered for next time.
4. Go through the folder and mod lists and untick anything you would rather not share. Unticking a folder also unticks the mods in it. The search box narrows what you are looking at; **Include all** and **Exclude all** always apply to every mod, not only the ones showing.
5. Then either **Save to templates folder**, which writes a `.json` you can send to anyone, or **Copy share code**, which puts the whole template on your clipboard as one line of text.

Some things worth knowing:

- **Export uses where your mods are now**, not any proposals sitting on Review Changes. If you have sorted but not applied, the template describes your *old* layout, because that is the one your library actually has. The screen says so.
- **Saving closes the creator** and reports "Saved as ..." on the list screen.
- **Share codes only work for small templates.** A chat message holds about 2000 characters, which is roughly a hundred mods. Past that the button is disabled and the screen tells you the length — send the file instead.
- **Mods sitting loose at the top level are left out.** A template only carries folders, so a mod that is not in one has nothing to record. The screen tells you how many.
- If two of your mods have names that match once suffixes and tags are stripped, and they are in *different* folders, that name is left out and the screen says so — a template cannot say two things about one name. Exclude one of them to include the other.

Help



Every explanation the plugin holds, at reading length rather than tooltip length. It is grouped into collapsible sections: what the plugin does, what is and isn't safe, one section per tab, what to do if an operation was interrupted, and where your files live.

Each tab's section lists that tab's controls with the same one-line explanation you get by hovering them, so the Help tab doubles as a reference for anything you saw a tooltip on and want to find again.

The four buttons

"Join the Discord for support" opens the project's Discord in your browser. That is the fastest place to get help, and where releases and testing builds are announced.

"Open the full guide in your browser" opens this document, pinned to the release you're running rather than to the latest one, so it always describes the version you actually have.

"Open the guide as a PDF" opens the same guide as a PDF, pinned the same way. It is generated from this document, so the two cannot describe different versions.

"Show the walkthrough" reopens the guided first run, the eight-step tour shown the first time you open the plugin. While it runs, the plugin window behind it switches to the tab each step describes and outlines the button to press (Refresh mod list, Sort, Apply). It can be reopened as often as you like.

If you upgraded to 0.6.0 from an earlier version, that walkthrough runs once for you too. That is deliberate rather than a mistake: 0.6.0 replaced the whole Sort control, changed how NPC names are matched, and added this tab, so there is as much new for an existing user as for a new one. Dismiss it and it will not return.

Nothing on this tab changes anything - it reads no mods and writes no files.

Hair

Hair mods that ship one folder per race can be filed under the hair number most races use. All three controls — Split hair by hair number, Priority race, and Midlander fallback — are on the Sort tab and are described under Sort above. Both extra controls apply only while Split hair is on, and all three are remembered between sessions.

Read the caveat at the bottom of this page before trusting the numbers on a library you care about.

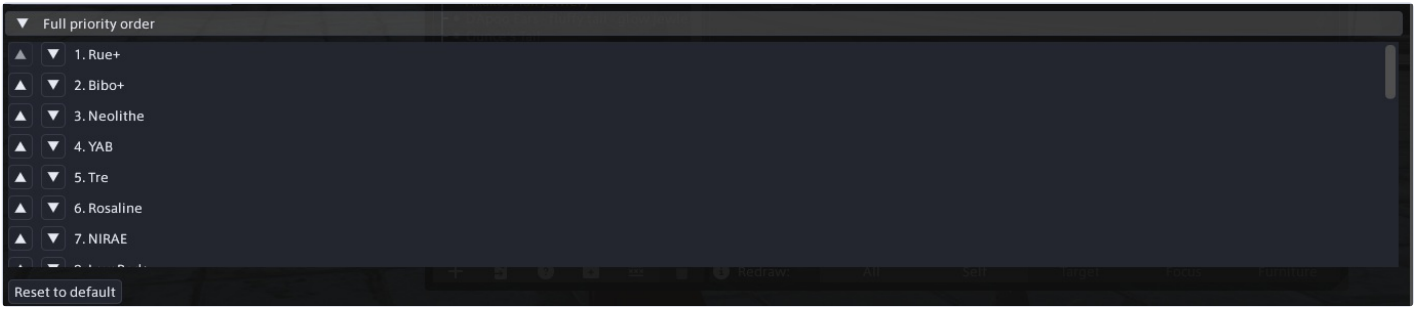
Body type

Gear can be put in folders named after the body it was made for, so everything that fits one body sits together. That is worth having when you change body and need to know what still works. The controls are **Split gear by body type** and **Split body mods by body type** on the Sort tab, described under Sort above.

The body comes from the mod's options and files first, then its name, then the library folders above it. Only gear in the Top, Hands, Legs and Feet slots is looked at, so weapons, hats and jewellery never get a body folder.

Body priority

In the Body type section of the Sort tab is a collapsed **Body priority** section, always shown. When a mod supports more than one body, it is filed under the highest-ranked one. Use the up and down arrows to reorder, or **Reset to default**. A **First-choice body** dropdown moves one body straight to rank 1.



The order is saved between sessions, and so are the hair priority race, the Midlander fallback, Group by and the split checkboxes. The order is applied when you press Sort, so reordering and sorting again re-files mods without a rescan.

To add bodies the plugin does not know, create `body-type-list.json` in the configuration folder; see Where files live. Read the caveat at the bottom of this page first.

Typical workflows

First-time sort: Scan, choose a grouping on the Sort tab and press Sort, review the proposed paths on Review Changes, then Apply.

New mods installed since the last sort: Scan again (this picks up the new mods; previously-set protection carries over), press Sort again, review, then Apply.

Hand-tuning through Excel: on Review Changes, Export Workbook, edit destinations in Excel, then on the same tab Import Workbook, review again, then Apply.

Protecting a folder but letting one subfolder sort: on the Protect tab, click the parent folder's box until it shows a solid `[x]`, open it, then click the subfolder's box twice - once to give it its own rule, once more to make it `[-]`. Sort, and only that subfolder's mods are proposed for moving. If some mods in there are still protected by their own tick or by Heliosphere, use Unprotect N inside on that subfolder to clear those too.

Undoing an Apply, or going back further: open the History tab and Restore the snapshot from just before the Apply (or any earlier one). Protection doesn't block this, so it works even for mods you've since protected.

After moving mods around inside Penumbra directly: Scan, check the Orphaned Folders section on Review Changes, Clean Up Selected Folders, click Rediscover Mods in Penumbra, then Scan again to confirm.

Finding which mod changes a given item: open the Search tab, Build/Refresh Index, type part of the item name into "Item contains", then click a matching mod to see its full changed-items list.

Where files live

Everything the plugin writes lives under Dalamud's per-plugin config directory: `organizer-history.json` for rollback snapshots (Apply, Restore, and manual backups all share this one multi-snapshot history), `organizer-folder-backup.json` for Folder Cleanup's own separate rollback data, `organizer-export.txt` for the plain-text Review export, `organizer-diagnostics.txt` for the diagnostic dump, `organizer-workbook.xlsx` for the last exported workbook, an `operations` folder holding one record per Apply or Restore (the Failed mods window reads the newest), and `npc-name-list.json` for the NPC/enemy/boss name list, which is seeded on first run and updated in place by Refresh. The plugin also READS `body-type-list.json` from the same directory if you create one, to add bodies the shipped list does not know or correct

one it does; it is never created or written by the plugin, and is simply ignored when absent. Your protected mods and protected folders live in the plugin's own Dalamud settings file (reachable via Show Config File on the Review Changes tab), not in this directory. The plugin never writes inside Penumbra's own mod storage, with one exception covered in TECHNICAL_SPEC.md: Folder Cleanup's edits to `organization.json`.

Known caveats

See ROADMAP.md for the current status. The child-race-variant NPC classification fix is implemented but not yet confirmed against a real, in-game mod library. The NPC wiki-refresh path has no automated test coverage. Folder Cleanup detection can appear stale immediately after a large Sort or Restore. See the Review Changes section above for why, and for how to force a re-check.

Hair numbers are read from the mod's files, and also from the EST entries in its metadata. The EST value has not yet been confirmed in game to be the hair number. If a mod is filed under a number that is not the hair it replaces, turn Split hair off and report the mod name and both numbers on Discord.

Body types are read from the mod's options and files first, then its name, then its library folder. A mod titled for one body whose options offer only other bodies now files by its options, so some mods that filed by name before will move after a rescan. Review Changes shows every move before anything is applied. A mod whose config cannot be read falls back to its name. A mod whose content and name never mention its body will not be filed under one, and a mod that merely has a body's name in its title can still be filed under that body: "Rue de la Paix" reads as a Rue+ garment. Look over the proposed paths before you apply them, where one wrong guess is one line to put right. `artemis` is the one ordinary word kept on purpose, because it is the only name that body goes by.

Folder names with a `+` in them (`Gear/Bibo+/Top`, `Body/Bibo+`) work in game. If a mod is ever reported as failed with `PathRenameFailed`, the Failed mods window on the Review Changes tab names it and the path it wanted. The usual cause is another mod sitting exactly where a folder is needed; the plugin now moves such a mod aside first.

The reverse is not automatic: restoring a snapshot that moves such a mod back onto the path of a folder that still exists (the empty `Body/Bibo+` folder left behind) can fail the same way, because Penumbra keeps empty folders. Run Folder Cleanup on the Review Changes tab to remove the empty folder, then restore again.

Heliosphere and Proteus behaviour follows from how those tools find their mods (by directory, not by Penumbra path), which is why moving their mods is safe in the two non-Protected modes. The Proteus controls have only been exercised against test mods, not a real Proteus library; tell us on Discord if something there looks wrong.